appreciation for the defector. Jindal told him: 'We need to be sure your guys are not going to betray us. Moreover, all five are dreaded and most wanted. We are arranging for new passports and identities for them.'

In December 1986, Balwant and his four friends were issued visas for all the routes they needed to take. The R&AW, in coordination with the immigration authorities and the state police, cleared their visit, which they were told was part of confidence-building measures. The domestic spy agency, the Intelligence Bureau, was informed that the men were on a peace mission to persuade others to abjure violence and build a new life. Two weeks later, Balwant returned to London, but one of his friends stayed on. Jindal and Bhardwaj were furious to discover a traitor among them. A secret operation was launched to locate the man, but he had disappeared. Bhardwaj later learned that he had been killed in an encounter. When the security agencies recovered documents from the dead man, the fabricated papers startled them. He was on the blacklist. How had he sneaked into India? They never received an answer to their question.

In January 1987, Bhardwaj sent Jindal to London. The aftermath of the operation against Sandhu and the slew of other arrests had weakened the ISI network but Abdul Khan was still trying to revive anti-India activities. While the ISI and Khan rushed to fill the vacuum, the R&AW took further steps to neutralise the recruitment drive. Simpson's Divan, a tavern in London, had become the meeting point for Jindal, Clarke and Narayanan. New plans were made every day to ambush Khan's remaining network but none worked out because Bhardwaj was against covert action in British territory. Finally, they zeroed in on Tariq, who had offered his services to R&AW to spy on his